

Impact of Technology on Communication

The impact of technology is both positive and negative. But logically thinking, technology has bettered the communication process and has done negligible harm. This article discusses the overall impact of technology on communication.

The development of technology has considerably improved our lifestyle. It has made its impact felt on each and every aspect of life, including the communication techniques. The development of communication has seen huge progress; from the symbols to the latest swanky mobiles! Each century has seen a new addition to the ever-growing list of means of communication. The invention of the telephone by Alexander Graham Bell in the year 1875 was the first technological invention that impacted communication in humans to a massive extent. Other subsequent inventions like that of the Internet, cell phones, etc., further eased and changed the communication process.

Effects of Technology on Communication

Everything has both a positive and negative impact, and the impact of technology on the communication process also comes as a mixed baggage. In this article, we would be discussing the impact of popular technological elements like emails, telephones, cell phones, etc., on our means of communication. Mobiles and the Internet are literally the basic necessities these days. A majority of us would feel something missing in life, if there were no mobiles or Internet (Agree?).

Take the daily routine of a person in this tech-savvy world. The day begins with a "good morning message" on a mobile app and ends with a "goodnight" on the same app. The social networking apps/sites are a world in themselves, like a virtual world! There is the incessant use of mobiles and the Internet for communication, the whole day. To make the process quick and easy, there are modes like online chats, emails, teleconferencing, video conferencing, networking sites, etc., among other tools. Mobiles, emails, and social networking sites are the most popular means of communication among the current generation.

Positive Impact

Technology has transformed the once big and far world into a tiny global village. Thanks to technology, we now have the power to communicate with anybody on the other side of the world. The points below summarize these benefits.

No barriers: Communication is now easy; in case of situations when you want to convey something urgently to someone, mobiles and emails come in handy.

Strengthened relations: Technology has made it easy to keep in touch with old contacts, and has also helped strengthen relationships.

Better solutions: Technology has brought the world closer and promoted exchange of thoughts to find better solutions to any problem.

E-schools: Services like video-conferencing has made it possible to give best education to students via expert faculty on the web.

Impact on relations: Finding someone to date was never so easy, thanks to the dating and chatting websites! No one would disagree if I say - Technology is the rationale behind the success of long-distance relationships. Video chats and social networking sites have played a big role in keeping people in touch.

Development: Technological advancements in the modes of communication have promoted faster decision-making, and led to the development and progress of the world. Video conferencing has played a considerate role in promoting faster decision-making. Most of the businesses depend on technology for communication.

Negative Impact

The most prominent negative effect of technology - the charm of the good old world is missing. The letters, and lengthy face-to-face conversations have gone away, and have been replaced by texting or chatting.

Impact on interpersonal communication: The current generation lacks essential interpersonal skills (the ability to express the ideas and thoughts to others, face-to-face). A major reason for this tendency is increased frequency of communication through texting and chatting on websites.

Effect on nonverbal communication: Technological means have also affected nonverbal communication. Lack of face-to-face interaction has reduced the nonverbal grasping power of individuals.

Near yet far: Teenagers especially, are always hooked to the social networking sites. They are more close to online friends, but the gap between parents and kids has increased considerably. Communication is missing, parents are not techno-savvy and not used to the communication styles of their kids, and this has increased the generation gap.

Reduced social interactions: Consider the socializing among people. Life has changed a lot; there are no social meetings and get-togethers (the frequency has reduced). People are more bothered about their online life rather than the real social life.

Has led to many addictions: People have literally become addicted to the Internet and cell phones, and this addiction has led to many anxiety disorders. People addicted to the Internet feel lonely and isolated.

Malicious motives: Many people abuse the social networking sites and communicate to unsuspecting beings pretending someone else. This tendency of people has done more harm than good.

As you can see, the positive points of the technological advancements cover up the negative points. It all depends on how we use these means; use the technological means of communication for sane purposes, and don't abuse them for malicious motives.

Impact of Technology on Education

Technology plays a vital role in every sphere of life, and education is no exception. The advent of technology has deeply impacted the educational scene. For more on this, read on.

Technology is a gift of God. After the gift of life it is perhaps the greatest of God's gifts. It is the mother of civilizations, of arts and of sciences. - Freeman Dyson

Technology has certainly changed the way we live. It has impacted different facets of life and redefined living. Undoubtedly, technology plays an important role in every sphere of life. Several mundane manual tasks can be automated, thanks to technology. Also, many complex and critical processes can be carried out with ease and greater efficiency with the help of modern technology. Thanks to the application of technology, living has changed and it has changed for better.

Technology's Impact on Education

Easy access to information

Greater interest in learning

Increased retention of information

Robust information storage

Better presentation of information

Teaching made interactive

Knowledge sharing made easy

Technology has revolutionized the field of education. The importance of technology in schools cannot be ignored. In fact, with the onset of computers in education, it has become easier for teachers to impart knowledge and for students to acquire it. The use of technology has made the process of teaching and learning all the more enjoyable.

Technology is a teaching aid

Computers offer an interactive audio-visual medium. PowerPoint presentations and animation software can be used to present information in an interactive way. Owing to the audio-visual effects, this way of teaching invites greater interest from students. The method is equally helpful for teachers. Projectors and screens facilitate simultaneous viewing of information by a large number of students. Addressing systems using microphones and speakers make it possible for teachers to reach a larger number of students simultaneously. These teaching aids have led to improvements in student attendance and their

attentiveness in class. Interactive media have proven to be useful in increasing students' concentration levels.

Technology has made student life easy

Technology aids student expression. Students can use much more than just pen and paper to express themselves or present what they have learned. They can use software to make presentations and projects. This makes them more interested in the subject and leads to better retention of information. With technological aids, they can make easy-to-remember notes and a creative presentation of the information they have acquired. It won't be wrong to say that application of technology has made a student's life easy. It's easier for students to carry a PDA than carrying big fat books to school. An iPad is less bulkier than a pile of notebooks or an ebook reader much lighter than a book.

It's easier to store information

Computers enable better and more robust storage of information. If you weigh chalk, board, books, and notebooks against technology, you find that technology can substitute for any and all of these. Computers have replaced chalk and board; they can even do the talking sometimes while the teacher takes a step back and lets the presentations 'speak'. Digital libraries require no physical space and students and teachers sitting in different parts of the world can access the same library at the same time. Compact memory devices have replaced notebooks and a keyboard and computer mouse are the new writing devices. What may have required hundred pages of a book can be compacted into a tiny memory chip. It can take hours to write, but it takes only seconds to type. Storing data has become much easier, owing to technology.

Information is easily accessible

The Internet is a huge information base. It can be used as an effective tool for acquiring knowledge. All a web user needs to do is to key in queries to search engines. Users are presented with thousands of search results. There are several websites and web directories that offer information on literally everything in the world. And all this is just a few clicks away. Both teachers and students can benefit from this.

Technology has eliminated space and time constraints

Online education and distance learning have given a new dimension to education and higher learning. Even if students are geographically far away from each other, they can be a part of one classroom. Though not physically but virtually, they can. Many educational institutes offer online courses, which eliminates time and space constraints in acquiring education. Universities offer online educational programs wherein students can interact with their teachers over the Internet, access reference material from the University website, and earn degrees online.

Teaching is sharing

Thanks to the application of technology, education has become more collaborative. With plethora of information so easily available to students, they can be a part of the process; they don't need to remain at the receiving end. Owing to the use of technology, subject experts can come together to formulate courses, design assessments, and better the process of teaching. The day isn't far, when students located in different parts of the world will be able to seek advice from experts spread across the globe. Education will be customized then. It will cater to different learning needs and varying grasping abilities and interests of students.

Mutual impact

Today, computer education is a part of school and college curricula. Considering the wide range of applications of computer technology, it is necessary for each one of us to be computer-friendly. Considering the advantages of the Internet technology, it is important for each of us to gain basic knowledge of Internet access and web research. We live in a technology-age and hence, it is important for us to be abreast with the latest inventions in the field. With education, we acquire knowledge of the functioning and use of different pieces of technology. And with the application of technology, we can educate ourselves better. This is the impact that technology and education have on each other. Education boosts the use of technology and technology aids education.

The importance of technology in education cannot be stressed enough. The introduction of technology in the educational field has made the process of learning and knowledge-sharing, a more interactive and pleasurable experience. Perhaps, the greatest impact of technology on education is the change in perspective. The paradigm shift in thinking from local to global can be attributed to technology. Indeed technology is one of God's greatest gifts to mankind.

Why is Technology So Important Today?

Technology has become an integral part of our daily life. To understand why technology is so important today, read on.

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Have you asked yourself why technology is so important today? Just look around and you'll know why. Literally, at every instant of time, you are surrounded by technology. Whether you are working or

resting, you are always using technology. It is used everywhere and all the time. Its use has made life easy. We need technology. It's important. You ask why? Well then.

Places far away have come closer, thanks to technology. The pace of life has increased, thanks to technology. Communication is rapid, travel is fast, movement is easy, action is quick, interaction has sped up and so has life. Things that once took hours to complete, can be done in seconds today. The world is smaller and life is fast. Courtesy - technology.

Why is Technology Important?

Owing to the application of technology, our standard of living has increased. Our needs are met with greater ease. Technology has brought advancements in agriculture, due to which food produce has increased. Owing to the developments in engineering and architecture, building robust civil structures has been possible. Technology has boosted every industry. Businesses have grown, creating more employment opportunities. Advancements in technology have led to the evolution of newer and faster modes of transport and communication. The application of technology has boosted research in fields ranging from genetics to extraterrestrial space. The computer and Internet technologies are ubiquitous. They have changed every sector; be it medicine, tourism, education, entertainment or any other. Technology has touched every aspect of life, making it easier, better and different. Technology has changed living.

The World Lit Up! The discovery of electricity drove all the darkness away and the world lit up. If not for the use of technology, we wouldn't have been able to produce electric power or harness it. Today, it can be generated through various means because of technology. Heat energy (from combustion in fossil-fuel power plants, from steam in thermal power plants and from chemical reactions in nuclear power plants) is converted into mechanical energy that drives turbines connected to an electrical generator that produces electricity. Using overhead and underground cables, the electricity can then be distributed to the smallest of households in the farthest of world's corners, thanks to technology. What made it possible to use the various energy sources to generate electricity? Application of technology. How could electricity be channeled to places far away? With the use of technology, again.

Basic Needs... How would our basic needs be met so easily if not for technology? Man could meet his needs even before the birth of technology. But it was so difficult then and so rudimentary. Look at today's food - fresh, preserved or processed, food of any type is available at your doorstep just anytime. Clothing? Gosh, there's so much variety and much more comfort with different clothes for different occasions and seasons. Where does technology come into picture? Everywhere. From food to fashion, technology has a role to play. How else would so much of all this be produced? Look at today's shelters -

shelters? Tall buildings, big bungalows, luxurious apartments - how would they be built if not for technology!

...and MoreHow does water reach homes? With the help of robust water storage and transmission systems. How do homes get the warmth and cold as and when they need? Due to heating and air conditioning systems. How can food be preserved without getting spoiled? Because of refrigeration. How can civil structures be built under water? How can skyscrapers stand so tall? It's owing to advancements in civil engineering and architecture. Earthquake-resistant and fireproof structures we see today are also a gift of developments in technology. In short, we owe our luxurious lives to technology.

Businesses GrewBusinesses, small and big, need technology to thrive. They are growing and expanding across countries owing to technological advancements. It is technology that gives organizations the strength to spread their wings. If not for technology, how would complex industrial processes be carried out? If not for machines, how would large-scale production of goods be possible? If not for computers, how would the software industry have grown? Growing businesses create employment opportunities for people and technology plays a big role in business growth. That's how important technology is.

Communicating Became Easier!Technology has changed the way people communicate. Communication systems have evolved from pigeons carrying messages to emails and instant messages that travel long distances in seconds. Cellular technology and satellite communication have increased communication speeds and made 'connecting' easier. The Internet has enabled easy exchange of information over long distances. Even now, you could be accessing this page from a web server in some far-off country. Just a few clicks of your computer mouse can take you anywhere on the Internet. You enter an all new world without even realizing it!

Satellite and radio communication have changed the entertainment industry. Channels from all over the world are now available on your TV set, thanks to technology. Television shows and films can reach the masses within minutes after their release. Radio communication has made it possible to broadcast programs to the remotest of locations.

Learning Became InterestingThe role of computers and Internet in education cannot be ignored. The use of computers in teaching has made learning more interesting. Computers enable better storage and presentation of information, thus making the process of teaching easier and more effective. Educational

CDs are available everywhere. Lectures/lessons can be uploaded on websites, as PDFs or even as videos. This has made information more easily accessible and provided for better ways of knowledge sharing. Online degrees and training courses have led to spread of education. Today, people can continue learning even while managing their jobs, because online education gives them the flexibility to do so. And all the information in the world is so widely available, thanks to the world wide web.

Technology Boosted Scientific Research! Technology is as important in the healthcare industry as in any other. Right from easy communication between healthcare professionals and patients to computer-assisted medical procedures, it's technology everywhere. In the working of patient-monitoring equipment and surgical instruments, there's technology. In various diagnostic procedures from scans to complex therapies, technology has a vital role to play. Many medical procedures are mechanized. Even surgeries are simulated on and assisted by machines.

Technological development has never stopped. Nanotechnology has gone on to understand things at their nano level. Space exploration has gone on to explore extraterrestrial life. Genetic research has revealed how various traits or even hereditary diseases are transferred across generations. Processes like cloning and genetic engineering are attempting to alter traits in individuals. Artificial intelligence can make machines learn, thus developing intelligence in them. Fourth generation technologies in mobile communication have achieved amazing speeds in voice and video communication on cellular networks. Things we would never have imagined have come into reality due to application of technology.

At the heart of every piece of technology is automation. Technology automates the most complex of processes, be it in communication, education, medicine or any other industry. With the application of technology, critical and time-consuming processes can be executed with ease and in less time. Laborious and repetitive tasks are best done by machines (without getting bored!). People do not have to slog as much as they would have had to, if not for technology. With automation come efficiency and speed. They save human effort and time to a great extent and make life easy and comfortable. Nothing else has changed living the way technology has. And that's exactly why technology is so important today and will always be.